



starting to earn, I decided not to go ahead with the company. My wife was my friend from college life, and we were clear about getting married after securing the first job,” he explains.

Manish explained everything to his mother and was back to Gwalior the same evening after he had visited the project site. This happened to be the time when the state government of Madhya Pradesh was busy setting up the Malanpur Industrial Area, approximately 10 kilometres from Manish’s hometown. Big names, including JK Tyres and Cadbury, had already announced their intention to set up units in the area. LG had also announced that it would be doing a joint venture with Hotline in the area.

“The duo decided to have a CRT factory in Malanpur. I thought this was the place to be. It was a multinational company and being there would mean being nurtured in a very professional environment,” he shares with a smile.

He adds, “We trained ourselves in college to take lift for travelling from one point to another. Every morning I would take a lift to reach Malanpur that was about 45 minutes away from my home. I sat in trucks, lorries, on top of buses and many other things to reach Malanpur every day.”

The first time Manish got to see the LG Hotline facility it was in its greenfield phase. He recalls a huge parcel of land being levelled by JCBs and trucks. He went to the security guard and requested to let him speak to HR once. The security guard told him to visit the Delhi office as all the recruitment was being done from the Delhi office only. “I told him I was coming from Delhi and would not return to Delhi in any case,” Manish recalls telling the security guard.

“It was clear to me that something big was coming up on that parcel of land. I would meet the security guard every day and request him to let me meet the HR depart-

Some lesser known facts about Manish Sharma

Favourite dish	- Kalakand (Indian sweet), Moong-dal halwa, Palak paneer
Cars or bikes	- SUVs
Car I drive today	- Mercedes ML 350
Next possible car	- Toyota Land Cruiser
Book genres I love	- Philosophy, Research, Current affairs
Favourite actor	- Ranbir Kapoor, Dilip Kumar, Amitabh Bachan
Favourite actresses	- Kajol, Rekha
Favourite cuisine	- Japanese, Indian
Does Manish cook	- No
Favourite sports	- Cricket
Holiday destination	- Historical places like Egypt, or place like Masai Mara

ment personnel. Every time I would get the same answer that neither the DGM nor the head of the personnel department was present,” he recalls.

However, he never lost hope and continued travelling to Malanpur every day, taking lifts to reach the partially-constructed facility. He did not go to any other facility as he was sure that LG Hotline was where he wanted to start his professional innings.

“I would sit near a tea-stall, drink I do not know how many cups of tea, and go through the newspaper from morning to evening. Then came a day when an Ambassador car arrived on the door of the facility. A person rolled down the windows and started speaking to the security guard. Next moment, I was called by the security guard. I was standing there with the chief of security speaking to the person in the car. He was the DGM of the facility. The DGM told me to head to Delhi as all the recruitment was done from there,” shares Manish.

He adds, “I gave him the same answer that I wouldn’t go back to Delhi and requested him for an interview opportunity. I don’t know what he saw in me, but he asked the security to help me meet Rakesh Singh. This was the moment when I realised that I might be able to get a job there!”

Success is yours, failure is mine

Rakesh Singh’s first response to Manish was the same as that of chief of

security and DGM. He told Manish that the facility only hires from Delhi and does not conduct any interviews at this facility. Manish’s response, “Sir, I have already spent time in Nehru Place, Dharuhera, and other places in Delhi, and have no further intentions to go back there. Please take my interview!”

Rakesh Singh agreed to conduct an interview, but his first question to an engineer looking for a job was not related to engineering, not even remotely connected to it. The question was, “What are your views on Purulia Arms Drop?” This question, back then, had the intensity to shake not just engineers but students preparing for India’s most coveted exams like the Civil Services. Manish looked above and thanked the almighty for the question that Rakesh Singh had asked him! After all, he had been reading the newspapers for more than five hours every day while sitting at that tea stall waiting for the DGM to arrive, and Purulia Arms Drop was on the front page of every newspaper.

“I was reading about the Purulia Arms Drop in the newspaper from the last five to seven days. I might have not been able to answer a lot of other things, but this was my forte. That was how I got my first opportunity to work,” he shares laughingly.

Manish underwent training around commissioning of machines, cold run, trial runs, production, and a lot of other things here. It was his first job, but he was already being trained to set up a facility from